To help make India's case, the Indian finance minister traveled to Washington in September. He welcomed not just aid, but private capital, emphasizing that India was trying its best "to consolidate [its] political freedom by economic progress."[36] Indian officials were hopeful that growing US concern about Moscow moving ahead in the missile and industrial race and about China would drive calls for more aid for India.[37] Nehru told Egyptian leader Gamal Abdel Nasser frankly, "Americans are afraid of China and regard [India] as a balancing factor," and this had made the US "more inclined to help us than before."[38]

Concern about China, particularly its developing military capabilities, did increase over the last year of the Eisenhower administration. And that concern contributed to the continued interest in strengthening India.[39] In May 1960, the administration signed another PL-480 agreement—the four-year $1.276 billion program was the largest of its kind. In the last few months of the administration, there was reportedly also consideration of an increased amount of $300 million for India for FY1961.[40]

By the end of the Eisenhower years, there was a sense of optimism about India. An intelligence assessment in October noted that long-term threats remained to its stability and unity, but it highlighted the "considerable progress in constructing the foundations of a modern democratic state" that India had made. Moreover, it expected that Indian "military attention" would be directed even more toward China in the years ahead. Finally, the assessment expected that India would continue to look to the free world rather than the communist world for further assistance.[41] One of the many reasons for this conclusion was that the communist world no longer looked as friendly to India as it had in the past.

From Hindi-Chini Bhai-Bhai to Zhou Enlai Hai-Hai (1959–1960)

In 1957, Nehru had commented, "All history shows us that friends and allies sometimes become enemies and enemies become friends."[42] And over the next few years, China and India did change from being friends to becoming enemies. Two developments in 1959 hastened that process: the Sino-Indian border dispute and an uprising in Tibet. By 1960, only six years after Indians had greeted Zhou with chants of *Hindi-Chini bhai-bhai*